Serena Ionta

Postdoctoral Researcher | Baffi Centre | Bocconi University
Via Guglielmo Röntgen 1, 20136 Milan, Italy | Office 5A2-08
✉ serena.ionta2@unibocconi.it | iontaserena.github.io
Citizenship: Italian

Research Interests

Applied Macroeconomics, Macro-Finance, Time-Series Econometrics

Academic Positions

May 2025 – Present
Postdoctoral Researcher, Baffi Centre, Bocconi University

March 2026 – Present
Affiliated Researcher, Macro-Finance Research Unit, Baffi Centre, Bocconi University

May 2024 – May 2025
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Bocconi University (GRINS Project)

Education

2020 – 2024
Ph.D. in Economics, Roma Tre University
Thesis: *The Fiscal-Monetary Policy Mix: A Theoretical and Empirical Analysis*
Advisors: Francesco Giuli (Roma Tre), Antonio Afonso (ISEG, University of Lisbon), Valeria Patella (Sapienza)

March – August 2023
Visiting Ph.D. Student, ISEG – Lisbon School of Economics & Management (UECE/REM)
Host: Antonio Afonso

2018 – 2020
M.Sc. in Economics, with honours, Sapienza University of Rome

2014 – 2018
B.Sc. in Economics, Sapienza University of Rome

Job Market Paper

Uncertain Climate Policy as a Source of Macro-Financial Shocks: Evidence from Carbon Futures Volatility (with M. Guidolin)
BAFFI Centre Research Paper No. 262, 2026. [PDF]

Publications

Predicting Commodity Returns with Climate Variables: Statistical Loss Functions vs. Economic Value (with M. Guidolin)
Economics Letters, 2026. [DOI]

Predictive Sorting of Cryptocurrencies Based on Fundamentals and Sentiment (with M. Guidolin)
Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions and Money, 2026. [DOI]

Monetary Policy Surprise Shocks under Different Fiscal Regimes: A Panel Analysis of the Euro Area (with A. Afonso and J. Alves)
Journal of International Money and Finance, 2025. [DOI]

Monetary/Fiscal Policy Dominance and Conflicts: Evidence from Crises (with F. Giuli and V. Patella)

Economics Letters, 2025. [DOI]

Forecasting Asset Returns Using Nelson–Siegel Factors Estimated from the US Yield Curve (with M. Guidolin)
Econometrics, 2025. [DOI]

Monetary Policy Surprises and Fiscal Sustainability: The Case of the Euro Area (with A. Afonso and J. Alves)
Economic Change and Restructuring, 2025. [DOI]

Working Papers

Fiscal Policies Are Not All Alike: Composition Effects, Regime Switching and Uncertainty (with J. Creel and G. Traficante)
Sciences Po OFCE Working Paper No. 01/2026. [Link]

Uncertain Climate Policy and the Role of the Financial Stress Transmission Channel (with M. Guidolin)
BAFFI Centre Working Paper No. 285, 2026. [Link]

Uncertain Climate Policy and the Earnings Distribution: A Functional VAR Approach (with M. Guidolin), 2026

Macroeconomic Forecasting with Large Language Models: The Role of the Loss Function (with M. Guidolin), 2026

Teaching

Lecturer
2025 – 2027 **Financial Data Science** (M.Sc.), Bocconi University, 48 hours/year
2026 – 2027 **Econometrics** (M.Sc.), Catholic University of Milan, 28 hours
2025 – 2026 **Macroeconomics** (B.Sc.), Catholic University of Milan, 36 hours

Teaching Assistant (B.Sc.)
2023 **Macroeconomics**, LUISS University
2022 **Microeconomics and Macroeconomics**, Roma Tre University
2021 **Macroeconomics**, Roma Tre University

References

Massimo Guidolin, Bocconi University – massimo.guidolin@unibocconi.it
Jérôme Creel, OFCE – ESCP Business School – jerome.creel@sciencespo.fr
Antonio Afonso, ISEG – University of Lisbon – aafonso@iseg.ulisboa.pt

Fellowships & Grants

2025 – Present Postdoctoral Research Contract, Bocconi University (MUR–PNRR "Young Researchers")
2024 – 2025 Postdoctoral Research Fellowship, Bocconi University (GRINS Project, PNRR)
2023 Visiting Ph.D. Fellowship, ISEG – Lisbon School of Economics & Management
2020 – 2024 Ph.D. Scholarship, Roma Tre University (MUR)
2025 Research funding, Economy of Francesco Foundation – Fraternity Index Project (approx. €200,000)

Presentations

2026: EEA–ESEM Annual Congress (Dublin); Bocconi–Bristol Sustainability and Green Finance Research Workshop (Milan); RCEA International Conference on Economics, Econometrics, and Finance (Madrid); "Oikonomia" – Relationship, Care and the Economy, SUPSI (Manno)
2025: IAAE Annual Conference (Turin); Junior Milan Time Series Workshop, University of Milan; 2nd International Conference on the Climate–Macro–Finance Interface, Bayes Business School (London)
2024: 1st CAM-Risk Conference, University of Pavia; IAAE Annual Conference

(Thessaloniki); INFER Conference Webinar
2023: 11th UECE Conference on Economic and Financial Adjustments (Lisbon); Ph.D. Workshop, University of Lisbon; Giornata della Ricerca, Roma Tre University; Ph.D. Workshop, Roma Tre University
2022: Sailing the Macro – Workshop on Macroeconomics (Ventotene)

Refereeing

Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control; Journal of International Money and Finance; Journal of Financial Econometrics; International Journal of Forecasting; International Journal of Finance & Economics; International Review of Economics and Finance; Finance Research Letters; Research in International Business and Finance; Economic Analysis and Policy; International Economics; Statistical Methods & Applications; Cogent Economics & Finance; Economic Change and Restructuring; SINAPPSI.

Other Publications

L'economia di San Francesco. La profezia del poverello d'Assisi e le sfide del presente (with P. Santori, eds.)
Città Nuova, 2026. Edited book.

Economics and the Ethics of Care: A Response (with T. Freiberg and O. Komisarenko)
In *Rethinking Economics Starting from the Commons: Towards an Economics of Francesco*, Springer, 2023, pp. 43–59. [Link]

Giustizia
In *The Economy of Francesco. Un glossario per riparare il linguaggio dell'economia*, Città Nuova, 2022.

Summer Schools

2022 Time Series Models for Macroeconomic Analysis II (G. Pérez-Quirós), Barcelona School of Economics
2022 Panel Data Econometrics (E. Bontempi), SIdE Summer School, Bertinoro
2021 Bayesian Methods for Economics and Finance, SIdE Summer School
2020 DSGE-VAR Models and Forecasting, CIMS – University of Surrey
2020 History of Economic Thought, SEC – Scuola di Economia Civile

Other Activities

2020 – Present Member of the Assembly, Economy of Francesco Foundation (research group on indices and macroeconomic analysis for the Dicastery for Promoting Integral Human Development)
2022 – 2023 Editorial Assistant, Working Paper Series, Dept. of Economics, Roma Tre University
2020 – 2021 Intern, Italian Ministry of Economy and Finance (State General Accounting Department)

Skills

Programming: MATLAB, Python, Julia, R, Stata, LaTeX
Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Last updated: September 2026